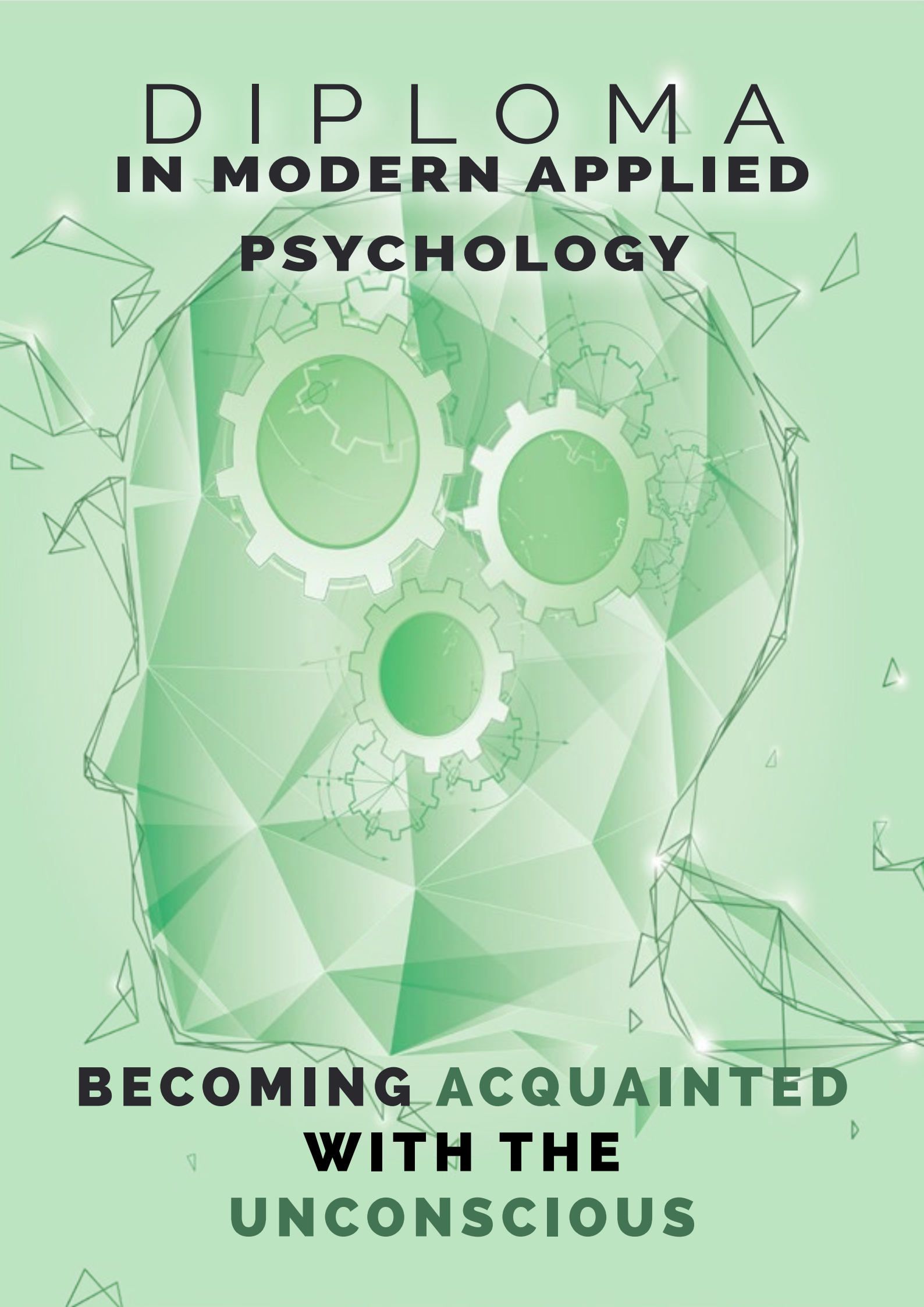


The background is a vibrant green with a complex, abstract design. It features a large, multi-faceted geometric shape in the center, resembling a stylized head or a complex crystal. Overlaid on this are three interlocking gears of different sizes, rendered in a lighter green. The entire composition is crisscrossed with thin, white lines that form various geometric patterns, including triangles and polygons. The overall effect is one of modern, technical precision.

DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

BECOMING ACQUAINTED WITH THE UNCONSCIOUS

BECOMING ACQUAINTED WITH THE UNCONSCIOUS MIND

Would you ever be friends with someone who attempted to sabotage your best intentions all of the time? The answer is likely no, yet most of us have this kind of relationship with ourselves.

Freud argued that everyone has a way of living life, a personal standard if one will, which only a few people ever focus on growing and strengthening. He referred to this standardised self as the ego. The ego is a culmination of our mind, will and emotions. According to Freud's theory, the ego is just one of three parts which make up our psyche, the other two being the superego and the Id.

The **id** represents our primitive, instinctual self. It consists of our biological and intrinsic personality traits (both those unique to us and those inherently human such as our libido and survivalist motives). The id is most prevalent when we are first born as it's the part of our psyche responsible for demanding our basic needs and urges to be met. The id operates out of the subconscious part of our mind and remains unaffected by our experiences and personal growth. It operates on what Freud referred to as a 'pleasure principle', which causes individuals to seek out immediate gratification, regardless of the consequences.

Have you ever felt as though there's something missing from your life which you cannot identify? Whilst we may not have the vocabulary to describe what we're missing in life, we're well aware of the obstacles which get in our way. If left unmanaged, the id is what drives individuals to remove all obstacles without a second thought for morality and ethics.

The **ego**, unlike the id, operates on a reality principle by mediating the infantile and selfish needs of the id with the world around it. It's responsible for rationalising and compromising our essential needs and demands by intersecting (to its best ability) the id when it encourages behaviour which may trigger negative consequences.

The ego, however, also seeks pleasure, or rather, aims to avoid all pain, but does so in a less irrational and animalistic way. The ego aims to serve the needs of the id in a more grounded and sensible manner. As our official shielder from pain, the ego is responsible for all the behavioural and mental responses to feelings of anxiety and distress. Whilst this problem-solving aspect of the ego is usually an effective, its solutions to many problems can be destructive when it indulges the id in the process.

The **superego** serves as our moral compass by incorporating the morals and values we adopt from both our family and wider society. Again, the superego's role is to manage and control the impulses of the id so that the individual can live a life in accordance with both their conscience and their ideal self (which the superego embodies). Naturally, when the ego falls short of the superego's ideals, the superego punishes the ego through chastisement and guilt. The greater the superego's idealisation of self is, the greatest the punishments the ego endures for its failure and perceived insufficiency.

The **wise mind** develops in life as we transcend the ego (our outlook, opinions, emotions and limited perspective) through continued introspection. It isn't controlled and motivated by anger, sadness, depression, anxiety, or fear, but by its own autonomous power. When we take ownership of ourselves, our cravings, pride, envy and lust, we grow in morality and maturity.



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What Are Core Beliefs?

In order to strengthen our superego, we must become aware of what our core beliefs are. Our core beliefs are the thoughts and assumptions we hold about ourselves, others, and the world around us. They are deep-seated beliefs which often go unrecognised and yet they consistently affect our lives.

Here are some common examples:

- I am unattractive.
- Everyone else is better at their job than I am.
- The world is full of selfish people.
- Everyone just wants to take and never give.

The above are all core beliefs. Our whole lives are dictated by such inner beliefs and, most importantly to note, sometimes our core beliefs are inaccurate! If you consider the examples above, you can guess at the influence they would have. In thinking that you are unattractive, you will no doubt struggle with your self-esteem and confidence. If you think everyone is better than you are at their job, then you may well feel small and unimportant.

If you consider that the world only wants to take from you, then you may find yourself reduced to cynicism, locked in a prism of seeing the world and its people in a negative way. This will affect what you offer to the world and what you are willing to give and share. Core beliefs affect what you achieve and how you operate in the world as a whole. Negative, and often inaccurate, core beliefs (like the ones above) will drastically reduce your chances of joy and self-fulfilment in life.

What are your personal core beliefs and are they accurate?

Here are some questions to help you look at the views you hold about yourself, other people and the world around you.

1) In what ways am I living outside of my integrity and compromising my personal values?

2) What have I left unfinished or unresolved that currently needs my attention?

3) What deep needs do I have that are not getting met?



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4) What am I fighting against that I can choose to release?

5) What legacy am I leaving behind in the world after I've gone?

6) In what ways could I be more engaged in life?

7) In what ways am I behaving inauthentically?

8) Who (or what) am I tolerating that I do not want in my life?

9) How am I making choices based on 'I should' as opposed to 'I want'?

10) In what ways am I behaving as a 'reactor' rather than as an 'initiator'?

11) How am I not accepting someone that I love for who they really are?

12) How do I diminish other people in order to make myself feel better?



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13) Are there any areas in which I'm holding back forgiveness, and if so where?

14) In what ways am I manipulating someone to get my own needs met?

15) What consistent negative thought patterns do I have?

16) In what ways do I allow other people to cross my boundaries?

17) What weaknesses or vulnerabilities am I afraid to share with those I love?

18) How am I completely present with those that I love when I am with them?

19) In what areas do I have a 'lack' mentality?

20) In what areas am I making my own life more difficult or complicated than it needs to be?



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21) Are my beliefs about life, religion, my spouse, my family, my children, the absolute truth?

22) In what ways am I using busyness, work, television, or the computer to avoid facing something?

23) How is my living space a reflection of my inner world?

24) In what ways am I compromising my health or mistreating my body?

25) What am I passionate about? How can I spend more time pursuing the things I'm passionate about?

26) In what areas of my life do I need to set goals?

27) How have I miscommunicated or created a misunderstanding?

28) How much of my time do I spend focusing on things of the past or worrying about the future?



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29) What events am I focusing on in the past that are hindering my ability to live fully in the present?

30) In what ways do I consider 'I'm not deserving or worthy'?

31) What relationships need my time, care and attention?

32) In what areas am I waiting for someone else to take responsibility for me?

33) In what ways am I allowing fear of change to hold me back from moving forward in life?

34) In what areas am I spending too much time on things that are not my priorities?

35) In what areas do I need to learn or further develop my skills in order to get ahead in life?

36) What would those close to me say my strengths are?



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37) What would those close to me say my weaknesses are?

38) In what ways am I not taking responsibility for the part I'm playing in a relationship problem?

39) How does my work reflect my interests, passions, skills?

40) Where am I prioritising money/material possessions over my relationships and values?

41) What am I allowing to distract me from living life to the full?

42) What is my vision for the next five years?

43) How am I helping other people to become better versions of themselves?

44) If I were to die tomorrow, what would I regret not having done?



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45) In what ways am I living a life someone else has defined for me?

46) What is my intuition telling me that I might have been ignoring?

47) What really pushes my buttons that really isn't worth being negatively affected by?

48) What drains my energy and in what ways can I change it?

49) In what ways am I being unwise or irresponsible financially?

50) In what areas am I so desperately longing for an outcome that it's preventing me from enjoying the journey?

